

Analysis of Five Recent DDoS Attacks

1. Aisuru Botnet Attack on Gaming Platforms — October 2025

- **Target:** Steam, Riot Games, PlayStation Network, AWS Cloud services.
- **Technology Used:** The **Aisuru botnet** launched a **TCP carpet-bomb attack** with a sustained rate near **29.69 Tbps**, one of the largest ever recorded. The distributed network of compromised IoT devices and servers generated short-duration, high-intensity bursts designed to saturate backbone internet capacity.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Believed to be demonstration or extortion. Analysts suggest Aisuru's operators sought notoriety or ransom leverage in the gaming sector while testing their botnet's capacity for rent-as-a-service schemes.
- **Overall Impact:** Short outages hit global gaming infrastructure. Riot Games disabled ranked matches, while Steam and PlayStation users experienced large connection failures during peak gaming hours.
- **Mitigation/Defense:** Widespread adoption of layered DDoS mitigation, such as **traffic scrubbing**, **rate-limiting**, and **upstream filtering**, can reduce the effect of such volumetric floods. Coordination between **cloud providers and ISPs** is essential for throttling high-bandwidth bursts at multiple network levels.

[1][2]

2. Gcore 6 Tbps Multi-Region DDoS — October 2025

- **Target:** Gcore, a Luxembourg-based gaming and hosting service provider.
- **Technology Used:** A complex, multi-vector **UDP flood** peaked at **6 Tbps** with **5.3 billion packets per second**. The attack originated mainly from **Brazil (51 %)** and the U.S. (24 %), showing widespread exploitation of unsecured routers.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Likely competitive disruption or botnet testing, consistent with prior Aisuru campaigns targeting hosting infrastructure.
- **Overall Impact:** Despite the huge traffic load, no customer downtime occurred because Gcore's global edge network absorbed and rerouted the flood using over 210 Points of Presence. The attack revealed the accelerating scale of threats against gaming cloud providers.

- **Mitigation/Defense:** Gcore's success demonstrated the value of **global edge capacity**, **AI-based anomaly detection**, and **auto-mitigation routing** that scales within seconds. Upgraded peering agreements between backbone carriers also minimized collateral congestion.

[3][4]

3. Cloudflare 11.5 Tbps UDP Flood — September 2025

- **Target:** Cloudflare's network infrastructure (unnamed enterprise client).
- **Technology Used:** A **hyper-volumetric UDP flood** leveraging compromised instances on **Google Cloud Platform**. Bandwidth reached **11.5 Tbps** in 35 seconds, making it one of the largest automated attacks ever neutralized.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Proof-of-concept and vandalism. Researchers believe the attackers attempted to stress-test hyperscaler defenses and exploit cloud resource misconfigurations.
- **Overall Impact:** The target's services remained unaffected thanks to autonomous filtering. The episode marked a 358 % year-over-year increase in volumetric DDoS traffic.
- **Mitigation/Defense:** Cloudflare's **machine-learning-based threat detection**, distributed global network, and **anycast traffic engineering** neutralized the deluge. Future protection relies on **cloud hygiene**—limiting misused compute instances and enforcing API rate limits on backend systems.

[5][6][7]

4. ISP DDoS Wave via Aisuru Botnet — September 2025

- **Target:** U.S. and Australian ISPs, including Global Secure Layer (GSL) and TCPSHield (Minecraft servers).
- **Technology Used:** The **Aisuru botnet** generated mixed **UDP/TCP packets** exceeding **15 Tbps**, creating intense traffic congestion at data centers hosting gaming communities.
- **Attacker's Motive:** Disruption of gaming platforms and reputation building within the DDoS-as-a-service ecosystem.
- **Overall Impact:** Temporary regional network slowdowns disrupted multiplayer gaming traffic and ISP QoS. Partial outages were felt across North America and Oceania.

- **Mitigation/Defense:** Broader deployment of **Project Shield**, **ISP peering blackhole routing**, and **dynamic ACLs** can prevent cross-region overflow. The incident highlighted the need for community DDoS defense sharing among cloud providers.

[2]

5. Cloudflare 7.3 Tbps Layer-7 Pulse-Wave Attacks — Mid-2025 (Ongoing in Q3 Reports)

- **Target:** Financial, telecom, and e-commerce companies globally.
- **Technology Used:** **Layer-7 DDoS bursts** using the **pulse-wave tactic**—rapid oscillating floods that overwhelm both bandwidth and application threads. Traffic hit **7.3 Tbps** with 37.4 TB transmitted in under a minute.
- **Attacker’s Motive:** Diversionary strikes masking concurrent intrusions. Attackers often deploy Layer-7 floods to distract response teams while exploiting lateral network weaknesses.
- **Overall Impact:** Network lags and temporary downtime for several fintech APIs, especially during trading hours in Europe and Asia.
- **Mitigation/Defense:** Defenses should combine **web application firewalls (WAFs)** with **real-time telemetry correlation** and **bot-behavior analytics**. Upgrading to adaptive Layer-7 mitigation prevents saturation of application servers even under fluctuating waves.

[8][9]

Summary of Recency and Magnitude

Incident	Date (2025)	Peak Bandwidth	Primary Vector	Noted Actor	Relative Recency
Aisuru Gaming Outage	October 6	29.69 Tbps	TCP carpet-bomb	Aisuru botnet	Newest
Gcore Hosting Flood	October 5	6 Tbps	UDP	Aisuru botnet variant	Newest
Cloudflare Attack	September 2	11.5 Tbps	UDP	Unknown (GCP source)	Recent

ISP / Gaming Wave	September 30	15 Tbps	Mixed TCP & UDP	Aisuru botnet	Recent
Layer-7 Pulse Wave Floods	August 2025	7.3 Tbps	Application (L7)	Multiple groups	Active through Q3

All five incidents occurred **within August – October 2025**, representing the **most current surge of global DDoS events** observed this year.

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